

Dining Area Interview Practice Questions

(answer truthfully; don't guess if unsure).

1) Where the dining area is + basic layout

- Do you have a separate dining area, or do you eat in the kitchen/living room instead?
- Where is the dining area located (between kitchen and living room, near a window, etc.)?
- When you walk into the dining area, what is directly in front of you (table, buffet, shelves)?
- How is it lit (ceiling light, chandelier, lamps)? Where is the light switch?

2) Dining table details

- What shape is the table (round, square, rectangle, oval)?
- About how big is it (seats 2/4/6/8)?
- What material/finish is it (wood, glass top, metal legs)? What color?
- Does it extend (leaf/expandable)? Where is the leaf stored?
- Where did you get the table (store/online/second-hand) and about when?
- Who paid for it or who picked it out?

3) Chairs and seating

- How many dining chairs are there?
- Do all chairs match, or are some different (bench, mismatched set)?
- Any chair covers or cushions? What color?
- Who usually sits where (each person's typical seat)?
- If you have guests, where do guests usually sit?

4) Placemats, tablecloths, and everyday table setup

- Do you use placemats, a table runner, or a tablecloth?
- What color/pattern are they?
- Where are placemats/tablecloth stored when not in use?
- Do you keep anything on the table all the time (fruit bowl, centerpiece, mail)?
- What's on the table right now (be specific but truthful)?

5) Typical meals and routines (dining-area specific)

- Do you usually eat meals at the dining table or somewhere else?
- Which meals are most often eaten here (breakfast, dinner, weekend meals)?
- What's a typical dinner you've eaten recently at the table?
- What time do you usually eat dinner on weekdays?
- Do you eat together most days or on certain days only?
- Do you use the dining table for other things (work, kids' homework, folding laundry)?

6) Dishes, flatware, and special items

- Where do you keep everyday plates and bowls (cabinet location)?
- Where do you keep glasses/mugs?
- Where is flatware stored (drawer location relative to dining area/kitchen)?
- Do you have “special dishes” (china set, holiday plates)? Where are they stored?
- Do you have serving platters/bowls? Where do they live?
- Do you have cloth napkins or paper napkins? Where are they stored?

7) Storage furniture in or near the dining area

- Do you have a buffet, sideboard, bar cart, cabinet, or shelves in the dining area?
- What’s stored inside (table linens, extra dishes, candles, wine, snacks)?
- Any display items (vases, framed photos, decor)? Describe 1–2.
- Do you keep extra chairs, folding chairs, or stools? Where?

8) Drinks, hosting, and special occasions

- Do you host guests often? Who visited most recently?
- What do you usually serve when guests come over (a couple real examples)?
- Do you have a wine rack or alcohol storage? Where?
- Do you use candles or a centerpiece for special dinners? Where are those stored?
- Who usually sets the table when you host?

9) Cleaning and upkeep

- How do you clean the table (spray, wipes)? Where are cleaning supplies kept?
- Who usually clears the table after meals?
- Do you use coasters? Where are they stored?
- Where does leftover food go after dinner (containers, fridge shelf)?
- Do you have a trash/recycling bin nearby for dining area cleanup?

10) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- What did you last eat at the dining table (yesterday/last weekend)?
- Who sat where the last time you ate together?
- Was the table cleared after that meal? What was left on it?
- When did you last wash placemats/tablecloth (if you use them)?
- Any new item recently added to the dining area (new chairs, runner, decor)?

Tip: If you’re not sure about a detail, it’s better to say “I don’t remember exactly” than to guess.